

JOB APPLICATION SUBMISSION

Pulse – Living Map

Challenge 01 · Local discovery product · Coded Next.js prototype

CANDIDATE

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ROLE

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PROJECT LINKS

Live prototype: deploy from the GitHub repo (Render). After it is live, the URL will be listed in the README.

GitHub: <https://github.com/arshansari2880-alt/pulse>

Design thinking: [/thinking](#) on the live site

RENDER FREE TIER MAY COLD-START FOR A FEW SECONDS AFTER IDLE.

What this covers

- 01 Final design — live map, pin system, categories, selected + quiet/crowded states.
- 02 Design thinking — problem, decisions, trade-offs below and on [/thinking](#).
- 03 Prototype — interactive Next.js app (pan/zoom, blooms, sheet, time scenes).
- 04 Exploration — clustering, pulse as data, quiet as a designed state, time as a scene.

Concept

Pulse is a city heartbeat map for Pune. It is not a directory of places. It shows what is alive right now — a gig starting in 12 minutes, a queue on FC Road, a street that went quiet at 1:14 AM. Pins pulse. Intensity is liveliness. Crowds become numbered blooms. Quiet is a designed screen, not an empty illustration.

Problem

The brief is not “put pins on a map.” Maps already do that, and they fail as soon as a street gets busy. The real problem is density: how do you show many live things without turning the city into noise — and keep the same system honest when almost nothing is awake? Location is the stage. Aliveness is the data.

Key decisions

- Pulse equals aliveness. Ring speed is the encoding. Lime is signal, never decoration.
- Three or more pins in a tight patch collapse into a bloom. Zoom splits them.
- A bottom sheet keeps the map as context. A modal would steal the spatial question.
- Filters ghost other types instead of hiding them, so the street does not teleport.
- Time is a scene: Evening / Saturday / Late. A living map that does not change with the hour is a directory.
- Type is glyph + behavior, not a second color. The brief gives one accent.

Trade-offs

No search bar — search is a query tool; the brief asks you to understand surroundings. No heatmap as the primary layer — heat shows density and erases identity. Stylized map instead of live tiles — geographic inaccuracy in exchange for visual control and a map that can go quiet.

Screens

CAPTURED FROM THE LIVE PROTOTYPE



DISCOVER · KOREGAON PARK, 8:41 PM



CROWDED · FC ROAD, SATURDAY 8:00 PM



SELECTED · OPEN MIC, FC ROAD



QUIET · 1:14 AM

How to review

1. Open the live link. Wait through a possible Render cold start.
2. You are in Koregaon Park at 8:41 PM. Pulse rings mean aliveness.

3. Switch to Saturday. Camera moves to FC Road. Pins collapse into blooms. Click a bloom, then a pin.
4. Switch to Late. The city goes quiet on purpose. Widen if you want the faint remainder.
5. Filter to Table. Other types stay as ghosts.
6. Read /thinking for the full case study.

THANK YOU FOR REVIEWING THIS SUBMISSION.
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